

Human trait: Excusing the inexcusable

It is one of the reasons why **mankind** has been unable to solve many national and international problems. **Man**, who is considered **rational**, **has** been using his **reasoning** in a wrong and **perverted** way. He has either been rationally explaining the defects of his personality and **flaws** of his character as his **sterling virtues**, or he has been using reason wrongly to justify his **uncivilised** behaviour as necessary for the well-being of his community or the security of his country.

He has been rationalising even his **vulgar**, **barbarous**, or animalistic behaviour as biologically 'natural', psychologically justified, and politically beneficial. Like, in the past, until recently, any **woman** who gave birth to many children **was** considered 'very **fertile**' and the father of those children was considered as 'potent', 'manly' or 'masculine' in character. In other words, people **adored** his **libidinousness** and her sexual **vigour**, rather than took notice of the lack of **self-restraint** or self-control on the part of the man and the woman.

Likewise, **one** who could **slaughter** large numbers of people, even for a **tyrant** ruler or for an aggressive and ambitious nation, **was** considered a 'brave warrior', a '**courageous** soldier' or a 'national hero'. In other words, people praised the quality of one's being a greater **butcher**, i.e. a killer, and less attention was paid to the quality of **forgiveness** or **compassion**.

Moreover, they rationalised aggression as an '**instinct**', as an in-built psychological response, or as genetically correct behaviour. It is this kind of **rationalisation** that has **resulted in** the present **state** of the world. Man's **faults** of character **have** now acquired global **dimensions** and are now threatening the very existence of society. Yet his attempt to **rationalise** his irrational behaviour continues to be. Man's **arguments** justifying his habits of smoking, drinking alcohol or taking a non-vegetarian diet also **are** due to his tendency to rationalise the irrational. **A matter** of more **pity is** that he does not recognise that he is arguing in favour of irrational and harmful behaviour.

Unless he realises this wrong tendency, no global problem can be solved. As **stated** earlier, this **tendency** to rationalise the irrational **has led to** small and individual defects taking the form of global problems. For example, man's **libidinous tendencies**, which were earlier justified on biological or psychological grounds, **have** now resulted in the grave danger caused by over-population, **promiscuity**, **illegitimate** children, rapes, **abductions** and the threat of the spread of AIDS.

The **threat** caused by overpopulation **is** not less than the one caused by nuclear weapons. Yet man does not try to have self-restraint, self-control or **continence**. Instead, he tries to rationalise his irrational and **errant** behaviour since that **suits** his **perverted** instincts, and emotions, and gives him short-lived pleasure even though it is a great strain upon his stamina and moral health.

The same can be said of his tendencies of aggression and **greed**. His justification of his self-interest and the wrong **notion** of security has led the world into the **morass** of grave economic imbalance and the race for war weapons. Hence there is an urgent need to put man's rational faculty on the right

track and, **thereby**, enable him to put an end to his irrational, irresponsible and injurious behaviour to save mankind from several global **upheavals**.

There was a time when defects in man's personality or faults in his character were considered as of individual concern. It was thought that society had no cause to **bother** about an individual's habits, as it was believed that these can, at the most, be of concern to one's family members or a few individuals who directly interact with that man. But now, with our better understanding, we know that **defects** in man's personality **are** of concern not only to that individual but to the whole society as well because individual defects add up to global problems. Smoking, for example, is not only injurious to the health of the man who smokes but it is injurious to others also who do not smoke but are **exposed to** tobacco smoke.

The libidinousness and the aggressiveness of individuals, as already explained, **have** now led to the problems of high population growth and a huge **stockpile** of war weapons respectively. The whole society has thus to suffer because of these habits of the individuals. **The way** to solve these problems now **lies** in the inner transformation of the individual but this is not possible unless man first **gives up** the habit of rationalising his irrational behaviour and justifying his bad habits of perverted instincts by **employing** faulty reasoning. [Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Trait** (noun) – quality, attribute, feature, characteristic, peculiarity गुण
2. **Mankind** (noun) – humanity, humankind, people, society, population मानवजाति
3. **Rational** (adjective) – logical, reasonable, sensible, coherent, sane विवेकपूर्ण
4. **Reasoning** (noun) – logic, analysis, thinking, inference, argument तर्क
5. **Perverted** (adjective) – distorted, twisted, depraved, corrupted, abnormal विकृत
6. **Flaw** (noun) – defect, fault, imperfection, blemish, weakness दोष
7. **Sterling** (adjective) – excellent, admirable, outstanding, worthy, fine उत्कृष्ट
8. **Virtue** (noun) – morality, integrity, goodness, righteousness, ethics सद्गुण
9. **Uncivilised** (adjective) – barbaric, primitive, savage, coarse, rude असभ्य
10. **Vulgar** (adjective) – crude, indecent, tasteless, offensive, obscene अशिष्ट
11. **Barbarous** (adjective) – brutal, cruel, savage, inhuman, ruthless क्रूर
12. **Fertile** (adjective) – productive, fruitful, rich, fecund, generative उपजाऊ
13. **Adore** (verb) – worship, love, admire, cherish, idolise पूजना / अत्यंत प्रेम करना
14. **Libidinousness** (noun) – lustfulness, lechery, sensuality, wantonness, salaciousness कामुकता
15. **Vigour** (noun) – energy, vitality, strength, force, robustness ताकत
16. **Self-restraint** (noun) – self-control, discipline, moderation, composure, temperance आत्मसंयम
17. **Likewise** (adverb) – similarly, also, equally, correspondingly, in the same way उसी प्रकार
18. **Slaughter** (noun) – killing, massacre, carnage, bloodshed, butchery हत्या
19. **Tyrant** (adjective) – despotic, dictatorial, oppressive, cruel, autocratic अत्याचारी
20. **Courageous** (adjective) – brave, valiant, bold, fearless, heroic साहसी
21. **Butcher** (noun) – killer, slayer, executioner, assassin, slaughterer कसाई
22. **Forgiveness** (noun) – pardon, mercy, absolution, clemency, leniency क्षमा
23. **Compassion** (noun) – empathy, kindness, pity, mercy, benevolence दया
24. **Moreover** (adverb) – furthermore, besides, additionally, also, likewise इसके अलावा

25. **Instinct** (noun) – impulse, drive, intuition, inclination, urge स्वाभाविक प्रवृत्ति
26. **Rationalisation** (noun) – justification, explanation, reasoning, excuse, validation औचित्य सिद्ध करना
27. **Result in** (phrasal verb) – cause, lead to, bring about, produce, provoke उत्पन्न करना
28. **State** (noun) – condition, situation, status, position, phase स्थिति
29. **Dimension** (noun) – aspect, feature, component, element, magnitude आयाम
30. **Rationalise** (verb) – justify, excuse, explain, account for, validate औचित्य सिद्ध करना
31. **Pity** (noun) – sympathy, compassion, sorrow, condolence, regret दया
32. **Stated** (adjective) – declared, expressed, mentioned, specified, announced कथित
33. **Lead** (to) (verb) – result in, cause, bring about, induce, generate कारण बनना
34. **Libidinous** (adjective) – lustful, lecherous, salacious, sensual, wanton कामुक
35. **Promiscuity** (noun) – immorality, licentiousness, wantonness, lewdness, indiscrimination व्यभिचार
36. **Illegitimate** (adjective) – unlawful, illegal, invalid, unapproved, improper अवैध
37. **Abduction** (noun) – kidnapping, snatching, seizure, capture, hijacking अपहरण
38. **Continence** (noun) – abstinence, self-restraint, moderation, control, temperance संयम
39. **Errant** (adjective) – wayward, deviant, misbehaving, straying, unfaithful भटका हुआ
40. **Suit** (noun) – match, fit, complement, accord, conform अनुकूल होना
41. **Greed** (noun) – avarice, covetousness, gluttony, acquisitiveness, rapacity लालच
42. **Notion** (noun) – idea, belief, concept, view, perception धारणा
43. **Morass** (noun) – chaos, mess, entanglement, tangle, confusion दलदल
44. **Thereby** (adverb) – thus, accordingly, as a result, hence, consequently इस प्रकार
45. **Upheaval** (noun) – turmoil, disruption, revolution, unrest, disturbance उथल-पुथल
46. **Bother** (verb) – disturb, worry, trouble, harass, pester परेशान करना
47. **Expose** (verb) – reveal, uncover, disclose, unveil, show उजागर करना
48. **Stockpile** (noun) – reserve, hoard, accumulation, cache, collection भंडार

49. **Give up** (phrasal verb) – abandon, quit,
renounce, relinquish, forsake त्यागना

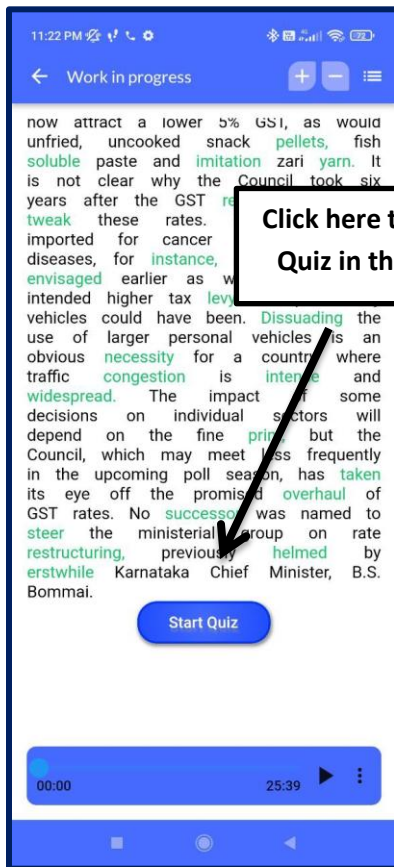
50. **Employ** (verb) – use, utilise, apply, engage,
implement प्रयोग करना

@mocks_wallah

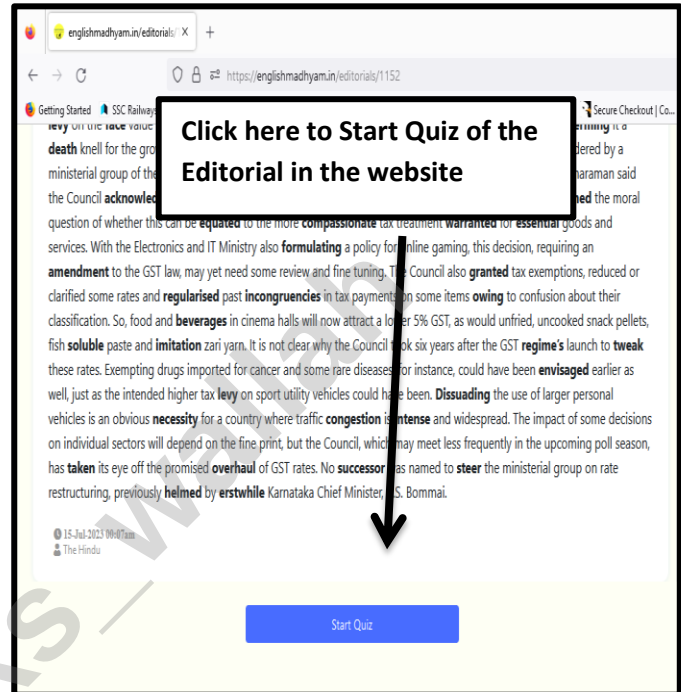
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Flawed Rationality:** Humans misuse their rational faculty to justify irrational, uncivilized, and harmful behaviors.
2. **Distortion of Values:** People often glorify personal defects and character flaws by labeling them as virtues.
3. **Barbarism as Bravery:** Violent or aggressive actions, such as mass killing in wars, are often celebrated as acts of courage and heroism.
4. **Sexual Excess Justified:** Excessive sexual behavior was historically viewed as a sign of fertility or masculinity, ignoring the lack of self-control.
5. **Aggression Normalized:** Aggressive behavior has been explained away as instinctual or biologically/genetically justified.
6. **Global Consequences:** These individual rationalizations have contributed to serious global crises such as wars, overpopulation, and environmental decay.
7. **Persistence of Excuses:** Even as these problems worsen, people continue to justify their destructive actions and habits.
8. **Addictive Behaviors:** Habits like smoking, drinking, and overeating are also defended using flawed arguments, ignoring their harm to self and society.
9. **Moral Blindness:** Many individuals are unaware that they are justifying irrational and harmful behavior.
10. **From Individual to Global:** Personal flaws and bad habits, once thought to affect only the individual, now have far-reaching global consequences.
11. **Public Health Impact:** Behaviors like smoking not only harm the user but also others exposed to them (e.g., passive smoking).
12. **Sexual Misconduct Fallout:** Rationalizing sexual behavior has led to problems like overpopulation, AIDS, and social instability.
13. **Aggression Fuels War:** Justifying aggression in the name of security has led to a dangerous accumulation of weapons and economic imbalance.
14. **Call for Transformation:** A deep internal change in human values and thinking is needed to resolve these global issues.
15. **Right Use of Reason:** The solution lies in redirecting man's rational capacity to support morality, restraint, and collective well-being.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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